

ZHIGANG YE

Artist / Researcher | London / Hangzhou | www.zhigangye.com

PROFILE

Zhigang Ye (b. 1997) is an artist and researcher based in London and Hangzhou. He is currently pursuing a PhD in the School of Arts & Humanities at the Royal College of Art. His practice-led research explores speculative fiction, archives, contemporary photography, glitches and poetics in contemporary images, and the visualisation and narrative structures of individual existence. It also engages with machine vision, generative imagery and technical images within contemporary visual culture.

EDUCATION

2025-	PhD, School of Arts & Humanities, Royal College of Art, London, UK
2020-22	MA Photography, Royal College of Art, London, UK
2015-19	BFA New Media Art, Taipei National University of the Arts, Taipei, Taiwan

EXHIBITIONS

2026	LOOP (6-9 May), Four Corners Gallery, London, UK
2026	RCA AI Festival 2026: Where Intelligence Meets Imagination, Royal College of Art, London, UK
2026	Shortlisted, CVPR 2026 Art Gallery (5-7 June), Denver, USA
2026	RAW: Unpolished Reality, Rock Bund, Shanghai, China
2026	Tidal Resistance (23-26 June), Palmer Gallery, London, UK
2025	Surfaced, Beaconsfield Gallery Vauxhall, London, UK
2022	RCA Photography MA 22 Degree Show, Royal College of Art, London, UK
2019	Reentry, Songshan Cultural and Creative Park, Taipei, Taiwan
2016	Taipei Free Art Fair: ARTasty / Taipei Art Freedom Day, Huashan 1914 Creative Park, Taipei, Taiwan
2016	INDEXING 2016 Outstanding Art Prize Exhibition, Kuandu Museum of Fine Arts, Taipei, Taiwan

AWARDS

2026	Photometria Awards 2026: Coming of Age (18+) - <i>Taste Like Salsedine</i>
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WORKS & PROJECTS

2025	I Wish You Were Here - Moving image, still images and installation. Centred on a spider never seen or captured, the project uses dice, prompts, archives and machine vision to construct a rule-based system, asking how unknown or unarchived events acquire visual representation.
2025	Map without Treasure - An image-based work using machine attention, coordinate data from vision-language models and diffusion generation to trace computational vision in an out-of-focus portrait.
2023	The Plant I Made - A photographic project assembling plant fragments into a fictional archive, interrupting linear, seasonal and Darwinian narratives of time.
2022	False Evidence of Plants - Still-life photographs constructing biased realities and possible forms of existence through assembled plants and branches.
2021	As a Cut of Light - An experimental work organising a laser cutter into a lightning-like artificial natural phenomenon.
2019	The Last Talk - An interactive moving-image installation and experimental film combining generated dialogue, performance and chatbot logic.
2018	Textless - A photographic series removing written signage from Taiwanese streetscapes to produce rewritten urban surfaces.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Speculative fiction; archives; contemporary photography; machine vision; generative imagery; technical images; anticipatory images; photographic temporality; glitches and poetics in images; individual existence and visual narrative.

METHODS & TECHNIQUES

Practice-led research; autoethnographic image and text recording; archive-based image practice; prompt systems; diffusion models; vision-language models; moving image; installation; photographic output; experimental editing workflows.

LANGUAGES

Chinese (native); English